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Consumers' intention to donate to two children's charity brands: a comparison of Barnardo's and BBC Children in Need

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Abstract

Purpose – This paper aims to examine consumers' non-profit brand image, brand typicality and past behaviour as determinants of intention to donate to two children charity brands.

Design/methodology/approach – Data for this study were obtained from two separate studies via a questionnaire, both in the context of two children charities, one for Barnardo's and the other for BBC Children in Need charity. A theoretical model is developed, tested and compared across the two charity brands.

Findings – Findings highlight that different factors influence intentions to donate time and money according to the charity brand. Brand typicality is a key determinant of time donations, while the impact of non-profit brand image dimensions on time and money donations differs across the two charities. Past behaviour affects intentions to donate money in both charities but impacts time donations in only one of the two charities investigated.

Research limitations/implications – The study examines specific dimensions of non-profit brand image across two different charity brands and offers theoretical insights about the value of brand image in a non-for profit context in shaping consumer outcomes (i.e. consumer intentions to donate).

Originality/value – The study sheds further light into the notion of typicality put forward by Michel and Rieunier (2012) for two children's charity brands that differ in terms of their strength and income levels and examined past behaviour as a determinant to donate to charity brands.

Keywords Brand image, Intention to donate, Past behaviour, Typicality

Paper type Research paper

An executive summary for managers and executive readers can be found at the end of this issue.

Introduction

The recent economic downturn in the UK and worldwide has resulted in government and corporate reductions in funding, suggesting that charities are ever more dependent on voluntary donations (Key Note, 2011). Additionally, the increase in competitive rivalry between charities and the intensified struggle to source voluntary income and obtain scarce, available resources highlight the need for charities to differentiate themselves from other charitable organisations. Given the “intangible” nature of charities' offerings (Venable *et al.*, 2005) and the high level of risk associated with such services, the ability of charities to differentiate themselves and their services is challenged by even more difficulties (Sargeant *et al.*, 2008). The value and philosophy of a charity is an

integral part of its existence and, as such, are non-negotiable (Stride, 2006; Tapp, 1996); consequently, any deviations from such values render charity brands meaningless. Charity brands serve as symbols of certainty, which offer donors “peace of mind”, whilst charity branding helps charities to conceptualise their purpose. In particular, branding enhances the perceived reality of what charities have to offer and reduces the risks associated with such offerings (Chiagouris, 2005; Grounds and Harkness, 1996; Stride and Lee, 2007). Hence, it is evident that non-profit branding plays an increasingly important role in the differentiating of charitable organisations, stimulating interest and even excitement about a particular charity (Hankinson and Rochester, 2005; Michel and Rieunier, 2012). Despite the ample evidence suggesting the importance of explicit consideration of brand management in a non-profit context (Bennett and Sargeant, 2005; Sargeant *et al.*, 2008), the “charity brand” remains underutilised. The failure of charities to appreciate and invest in their brand results in the neglect of these promising tools, such as branding, that can create longevity and future success (Davis, 2000). Coupled with limited resources, charities are forced to maximise all the returns on their business activities. To facilitate such returns, charities need to develop a sound image that will enhance both financial performance and the ability of a charity to influence consumer preferences and key external audiences (Sargeant, 1999; Sargeant *et al.*, 2008; Tapp, 1996).

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To address the role of branding in the non-profit sector, this paper focusses on non-profit brand image, brand typicality and past behaviour as predictors of the intention to donate to two children's charity brands; Barnardo's, (hereafter referred to as "B's"), and BBC Children in Need, (hereafter referred to as "CN"). A theoretical model is derived and tested empirically for the two different charity brands, using two different data sets, via structural equation modelling. The findings highlight the role of non-profit branding, brand typicality and past behaviour in charitable donations and contribute to an understanding of these key determinants for non-profit brands, in their attempt to increase charitable donations. More importantly, this research highlights the effects of four dimensions of non-profit brand image, (i.e. affect, efficiency, dynamism and usefulness), on charitable donations, examines and establishes the mediating role of typicality, as well as the importance of past behaviour in donating money and time to children's charity brands. By comparing two charity brands that belong to the same sector, albeit highly differentiated in terms of their financial situation, we show how key, non-profit, brand-related dimensions, such as affect and usefulness, translate into behavioural outcomes, such as charitable donations. Similarly, the study sheds further light onto the concept of "typicality" as put forward by Michel and Rieunier (2012), in directly and indirectly impacting upon intentions to donate to charity brands. Typicality emphasises that certain characteristics which relate to a given brand affect an individual's perceptions of the representativeness of that specific brand, indicating that typicality interacts with the non-profit brand image to influence key consumer outcomes, in this case, intentions. Findings thus highlight the variable weight of the key determinants of the intention to donate money and time between the two charity brands, resulting in interesting conclusions based upon the usefulness of the non-profit brand image and typicality in shaping donations, with significant practical implications for the two charity brands. Lastly, an additional contribution of the study derives from the study's research design and the use of two separate data sets, each capturing a separate charity brand, (i.e. B's and CN), which enables an empirical comparison of the theoretical model and the factors which determine intentions to donate across the two charity brands. The paper starts with a literature review of the key and relevant concepts, leading to the development of a theoretical model and associated hypotheses. The research design and methods are then presented and a discussion of the analysis and findings follows. The paper ends with some concluding remarks, highlighting the key contributions of this study for theory and practice.

Literature review

Charitable donations and the intention to donate to charity

Research into individual motives, intentions and ways of donating has been informed by a spectrum of studies belonging to the realms of anthropology, clinical psychology and classical economics, with many models and theories developed as a result (Hou *et al.*, 2009). In particular, social exchange theory suggests that donations are a result of cost-benefit analysis in that individuals compare the benefits of donating against the cost of such behaviour (Sargeant *et al.*,

2006). The parallel process model (Basil *et al.*, 2008) sheds more light on the factors affecting charitable donations by looking into the relationship between guilt and empathy, whilst the empathy-altruism hypothesis investigates the impact of consumer internal values on the decision-making process for charitable donations (Webb *et al.*, 2000). These models focus mainly on the donor's personal traits, helping to differentiate donors from non-donors of charitable organisations (Webb *et al.*, 2000). However, due to heterogeneity of those contributing to charities, the diversity of charitable organisations and brands and the types of donations, those utilising these methods are facing difficulties in effectively distinguishing donors from non-donors (Ranganathan and Henley, 2008).

Further, donations to charities come in different forms, including donations in time, money or in-kind goods and services. Donations in money are argued to be more of a rational decision, rather than an emotional one, which is the case with donations in time (Liu and Aaker, 2008; Michel and Rieunier, 2012), each leading to a different type of behaviour (Liu and Aaker, 2008). In instances of causal monetary donations, which can be categorised as a "low involvement" situation (Bennett and Gabriel, 2003), donors are influenced by peripheral cues, such as positive brand image, and are less motivated to process information in depth (Bennett and Gabriel, 2003). Drawing on the differences between time and money donations, research suggests that more human and social capital is required in instances where donations of time occur, as opposed to donations in money (Bryant *et al.*, 2003). Following on from the above evidence and the fundamental difference between time and money donations, this study considers the factors impacting upon both time and money donations, focussing on non-profit brand image, brand typicality and past behaviour, in an attempt to draw useful comparisons between money and time donations.

Non-profit brand image

A positive brand image for a charity is essential, considering that a unique, strong and favourable brand image permits the brand and its "meaning" to achieve positive differentiation in the minds of consumers which, in turn, contributes to the potential for enhanced brand equity and to the acquirement of new and returning donors (Pitta and Katsanis, 1995). Effective management of a brand image may reveal a positive impact upon charities' income generation, as was the case in several of the UK's high profile charities in the 1990s, which experienced an income increase of 10 per cent per annum soon after implementing changes (Denney, 1999; Kennedy, 1998). Scarce empirical results corroborate the positive impact that a favourable non-profit brand image has on the number of donations (Bennett and Gabriel, 2003; Michel and Rieunier, 2012). Despite the argued importance of the non-profit brand image and the uniqueness of the non-profit sector (Bennett and Sargeant, 2005; Sargeant, 1999; Saxton, 1995), little research has been dedicated to the concept of a non-profit brand image (Bennett and Gabriel, 2003; Michel and Rieunier, 2012). The conceptualisation of a non-profit brand image has been largely informed by literature on commercial branding and, in particular, from brand personality measures. For example, Aaker's five brand

personality dimensions, i.e. sincerity, excitement, competence, sophistication and ruggedness, have been adapted in the charity and non-profit context. Venable *et al.* (2005) and Sargeant *et al.* (2008) borrow from the brand personality literature, to capture non-profit brand image, suggesting that integrity and nurturance better serve the purpose of charity differentiators, compared to sincerity, excitement and competence. In addition, Bennett and Gabriel (2003) propose a set of five underlying dimensions of non-profit brand image, namely, compassion, dynamism and idealism, focus on beneficiaries and being “non-political”.

In spite of this stream of research, the non-profit brand image measures within the above-mentioned studies act as weak predictors of the intention to donate (Sargeant *et al.*, 2008; Venable *et al.*, 2005). On the other hand, Bennett and Gabriel's (2003) scale has a 69 per cent explanatory power, but the scale is predominantly grounded in commercial concepts rather than concepts used in non-profit branding. A recent study of Michel and Rieunier (2012), proposes a four-dimensional solution to conceptualise and measure a non-profit brand image, which proves to have a far greater impact on charitable donations in both time and money, in comparison to previous studies on a non-profit brand image. The authors argue that a non-profit brand image is captured by four dimensions that of usefulness, efficiency, affect and dynamism, also highlighting their separate impacts upon charitable donations in terms of money and time, in the specific context of humanitarian aid charities (Michel and Rieunier, 2012). Based on this stream of research and Michel and Rieunier's distinction between money and time donations, we hypothesise that:

- H1. Non-profit brand image will have a positive impact on consumers' intention to donate (a) money and (b) time.

Brand typicality

The notion indicating how representative an object is of a certain category is known as typicality (Nedungadi and Hutchinson, 1985). “Typical” products or brands are perceived as having higher value attributes, benefiting from first recall. Typical products are also classified in a more accurate and speedy manner (Ward and Loken, 1988) and can be used as reference points, in comparison with less typical ones. Previous research highlights the positive relationship between typicality and brand preference (Ward and Loken, 1988); however, the authors assert a word of caution, implying that typicality effects on preference and comparison may not be able to be generalised across all product categories and should be carefully evaluated before the connection is applied to a specific product category (Ward and Loken, 1988). Within the charity sector, typicality is proven to have a significant impact on the intention to donate money and time (Michel and Rieunier, 2012). Determinants of a charity's typicality, (i.e. being a representative brand in its product category, e.g. B's as a children's charity), involve how its mission category compares to others in the same group, the extent to which it meets the public's “ideal” charity traits and the extent to which the public is exposed to the particular charity (Loken and Ward, 1990). In line with previous research, which adopts Rosch's (1973) theory of

categorisation and prototypes (i.e. Michel and Rieunier's, 2012), and supports the impact of typicality on donations, this study models brand typicality as a predictor of the intention to donate money and time across two different charity brands (H2). Michel and Rieunier (2012, p. 702) argue that “a product is typical of a brand when it is perceived as consistent with the brand's image”, although the authors did not account for potential interactions between typicality and the non-profit brand image. However, we argue that for consumers to be able to assess that a brand is typical or atypical of its product category (e.g. Louis Vuitton as typical of luxury brands), they should firstly be informed by the image of the brand. To this end, brand image allows consumers to make assessments about whether a brand is representative of its product category. Based on this reasoning and in contrast to Michel and Rieunier (2012), we model typicality as interacting with a non-profit brand image (H3). In particular, we anticipate that the non-profit brand image will influence typicality, as characteristics pertaining to a given brand are likely to affect perceptions of the representativeness of that brand. Hence:

- H2. Brand typicality will positively impact upon consumers' intention to donate (a) money and (b) time.
- H3. Non-profit brand image will positively impact upon brand typicality.
- H4. Brand typicality will mediate the relationship between non-profit brand image and consumers' intention to donate (a) money and (b) time.

Past donations

It is argued that past behaviour acts as a risk reducer, leading to a situation where a positive experience in the past will most likely lead to repeated behaviour, as the perceived risk associated with such an action is far less in such instances (Sargeant *et al.*, 2008). In the context of charity donation, past donation behaviour is shown to be an essential determinant of future donation (Cheung and Chan, 2000; Diamond and Kashyap, 1997; Ouellette and Wood, 1998; Sutton, 1994). Thus, more favourable intentions are likely to be developed towards the acts performed frequently in the past (Ouellette and Wood, 1998). Similarly, Lee *et al.* (1999) also argue that past behaviour is a significant predictor of the intention to donate, suggesting that repeated or habitual actions will most likely result in an increase in donations (Camic, 1986). Hence:

- H5. Past donation behaviour will positively impact upon consumers' intention to donate (a) money and (b) time.

Demographic variables affecting the intention to donate (control variables)

Previous research suggests that demographic factors, such as social status, sex, age and income, influence behavioural intention and behaviour in multiple contexts (Iversen and Kraft, 2006; Verbeke, 2005; Wee *et al.*, 1995). In the context of charitable donations, it has been established that females are more likely to donate to a charity as compared to males (Mesch *et al.*, 2011; Piper and Schnepf, 2007). In addition, voluntary donations have been shown to increase as age increases (Halfpenny, 1991; Schlegelmilch *et al.*, 1997) and,

as far as income is concerned, an increase in income (which in general increases with age and experience) has been connected to an increase in altruism (Kitchen and Dalton, 1990; Schlegelmilch *et al.*, 1997), manifested in the form of an obligatory feeling to donate (Ranganathan and Henley, 2007). Based on the above and in line with previous research, age, gender and income are included as control variables in the theoretical model shown below.

Theoretical model

Drawing on the above literature, a theoretical model (Figure 1) has been developed and tested empirically, using structural equations modelled in the context of the two children's charity brands, B's and CN. Consistent with the literature reviewed, the model theorises that the non-profit brand image, (directly and indirectly), as well as typicality and past behaviour, impact upon the intention to donate. In line with Michel and Rieunier (2012), we decided to assess the impact of each non-profit brand dimension individually on typicality and the intention to donate to gain a detailed understanding of each dimension's individual contribution. Thus, we did not investigate a higher order variable (e.g. non-profit brand image) but rather each dimension individually, in line with Michel and Rieunier (2012). Hence, it is argued that:

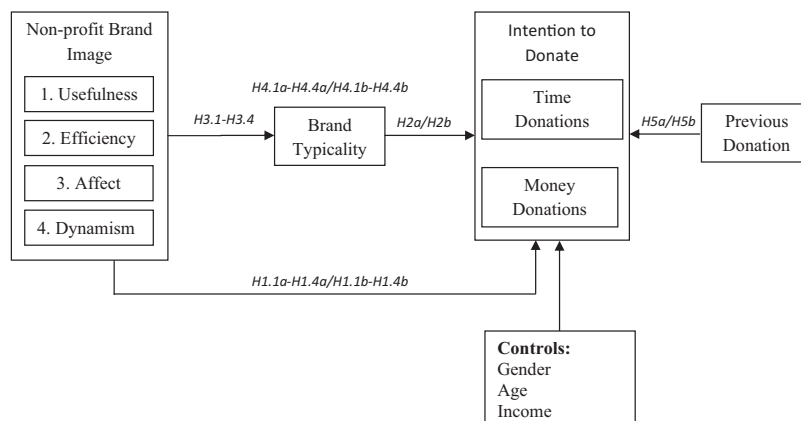
- Usefulness will positively impact money (H1.1a) and time (H1.1b) donations;
- Efficiency will positively impact money (H1.2a) and time (H1.2b) donations;
- Affect will positively impact money (H1.3a) and time (H1.3b) donations; and
- Dynamism will positively impact money (H1.4a) and time (H1.4b) donations. Additionally, we modelled each of the brand image dimensions separately impacting upon typicality and typicality mediating the relationship between each brand image dimension and money and time donations. Finally, age, gender and income were used as control variables.

Methodology

Context and sample

The model was tested on two charity brands within the same charitable sector which allows for a comparison of the results. We focussed on the child and youth charity sector. This sector had been selected following a pre-test, which sought for a strong "spontaneous recognition" of charities among respondents. Respondents were asked to name the charitable sector that first came into their mind. The results of the pre-test showed that the child and youth charity sector was the most recognisable charity sector among respondents. Consequently, we decided to include two charities from the child and youth sector, including B's and the CN Appeal. The reason for choosing these two children's charity brands was guided by their contrasting income levels; B's with an excess of £244 million and CN, with an excess of £40.20 million (Charities Aid Foundation, 2012). On the other hand, according to the Third Sector Research (2012)[1] Charity Brand Index, CN appears to be a stronger brand when compared to B's, being ranked fourth in the list of the 125 top charity brands, with B's appearing as 28th. Although B's appears to be a weaker brand, their spending on encouraging voluntary income is seven times higher than that of CN (Figures a1 and a2). One would assume that considering B's amount of spending in income-generating activities, B's image would have a much higher influence on the intention to donate money as compared to that of CN, making these two charities suitable for investigating the intention to donate. Following the selection of these two charity brands, a second pre-test was conducted, with the purpose of ensuring that consumers were aware of both brands and, therefore, that they had sufficient knowledge to complete the survey. The results of the second pre-test highlighted a high level of awareness and recognition for both of the chosen charity brands. Subsequently, data were collected via two separate self-administered questionnaires from two different groups of respondents. The first group of respondents was asked to answer questions pertaining to the B's brand and the second group of respondents were asked questions that referred to the CN brand. Data was collected online via a survey posted on social networking sites, as well as

Figure 1 presents the model with associated hypotheses



Source: Charity commission (2012a)

offline via the intercept approach in multiple locations within a University campus and a shopping centre. Respondents unfamiliar with both charity brands in both data collection procedures were excluded from the sample. In total, 200 and 151 respondents, respectively, fully completed the questionnaire (Table I).

Measures

A questionnaire was prepared, containing four sections. Existing measures were used to capture all the predictors of the intention to donate. In particular, the first section involved a measurement for a non-profit brand image, derived from Michel and Rieunier (2012) using a scale of 14 items, capturing four dimensions, namely, usefulness, efficiency, affect and dynamism. We used this measure of a non-profit brand image as compared to others (Sargeant *et al.*, 2008; Venable *et al.*, 2005), as it is the latest, grounded on scholarly research and has a good predictive validity. The following section of the questionnaire addressed brand typicality of the charity, which was measured in line with Rosch and Mervis (1975). In particular, respondents were asked to rate the following: "[Non-profit organisation X] is a representative brand of the Children and Youth Charity sector", and "[Non-profit organisation X] is a good brand example of the Children and Youth Charity sector". The third section included measures of previous donations as well as their intentions to donate time and money. Previous donation was measured by a single item, whilst the intention to donate time and money was based on the Michel and Rieunier's (2012) study and involved questions such as: "If I were to contribute some money to a non-profit organisation, I would contribute to X" and "If I were to contribute some personal time to a non-profit organisation, I would contribute to X". Particular attention was paid at this point, so that the intentions to donate time and money were recorded separately, as volunteering in time is believed to require more involvement and, therefore, may generate different results from donating

money (Michel and Rieunier, 2012). The last section asked for demographic information and included gender, age and income.

Analysis and findings

Prior to testing the model, the non-profit brand image scale was subjected to confirmatory factor analysis (CFA), using maximum likelihood estimation (ML). Using Lisrel 8.71, all study items were tested in a single CFA model for B's and CN separately. Regarding the non-profit brand image scale, we followed the Michel and Rieunier (2012) procedure and restricted the items to load on their respective four factors of the original non-profit brand image scale. Considering that the study involved two samples (B's and CN) and to be able to proceed with the analysis and compare the results, we followed procedures by Jöreskog and Sörbom (1989) in assessing measurement invariance between the two groups. In particular, we examined whether the variables show the same pattern of significant factor loadings across the two groups. We tested for the goodness-of-fit of the two-sample model and restricted all common factor loadings to be invariant across the groups. Initial results indicated a good fit for B's $\chi^2 (71) = 121.17$, root mean square error of approximation (RMSEA) = 0.06, goodness-of-fit index (GFI) = 0.92, comparative fit index (CFI) = 0.986, normed-fit index (NFI) = 0.967 and standardised root mean square residual (RMR) = 0.05 and a fairly good fit for CN sample: $\chi^2 (71) = 143.473$, RMSEA = 0.08, GFI = 0.883, CFI = 0.975, NFI = 0.952 and standardised RMR = 0.054. However, discriminant validity of non-profit brand image scales' dimensions was not achieved for either sample. After several iterative processes, a satisfactory model fit was achieved in both samples, as well as discriminant validity between the dimensions of non-profit brand image scales for both samples: $\chi^2 (10) = 18.814$, RMSEA = 0.066, GFI = 0.974, CFI = 0.99, NFI = 0.979 and standardised RMR = 0.0247 for B's and $\chi^2 (10) = 11.392$, RMSEA = 0.03, GFI = 0.979, CFI = 0.998, NFI = 0.986 and standardised RMR = 0.0245 for the CN sample. Items of non-profit brand image scale and factor loadings are shown in Table II.

Descriptive statistics as well as the Cronbach's alpha values for the constructs used in the study can be found in Table III.

We also took into consideration the potential issues with common method variance (CMV), considering that the data for this study were obtained through self-reports. Following Podsakoff *et al.* (2003), respondents were guaranteed anonymity of response and were not informed about the specific purpose of the research. In addition, we compared two single-factor confirmatory analyses, one for the B's sample items and the other for the CN sample items, where we constrained all item loadings to a single factor, with the unconstrained models in both samples. The fit indices of the unconstrained models were unacceptable; the unconstrained model did not fit the data significantly better than the constrained single-factor model in either of the two samples, indicating that the CMV does not represent a threat to present constructs. In addition, we assessed the extent to which multicollinearity can affect model estimation in both samples. We followed several recommendations and assessed the multicollinearity threat by examining the discriminant validity

Table I Sample profile

Variables	n		Percentage (%)	
	B's	CN	B's	CN
Gender				
Male	93	52	46.5	34.4
Female	107	99	53.5	65.6
Age				
20 and under	98	16	49	10.6
21-30	101	61	50.5	40.4
31-40	–	10	–	6.6
41-50	1	22	0.5	14.6
51 and over	–	42	–	27.8
Income				
Less than £10,000	185	61	92.5	40.4
£10,000-£20,000	9	31	4.5	20.5
£20,000-£30,000	1	30	0.5	19.9
£30,000-£40,000	1	11	0.5	7.3
£40,000 plus	4	18	2	11.9

Notes: B's=Barnardo's charity; CN=BBC Children in Need charity

Table II Non-profit brand image dimensions

Items	Usefulness		Non-profit brand image dimensions				Dynamism	
	B's	CN	Efficiency		Affect		B's	CN
Civic-minded	0.842	0.837						
Well-managed			0.739	0.723				
Uses assets wisely			0.781	0.839				
Friendly					0.879	0.884		
Warm					0.896	0.793		
Engaging					0.769	0.840		
Innovative							0.836	0.855

Table III Descriptive statistics and alpha coefficients

Dimensions	Means		SD		Cronbach's alpha	
	B's	CN	B's	CN		
Usefulness ^a	4.10	4.32	0.737	0.820	–	–
Efficiency	3.52	3.57	0.703	0.797	0.67	0.7
Affect	3.54	4.00	0.704	0.810	0.74	0.83
Dynamism ^a	3.01	3.99	0.872	0.945	–	–
Typicality	3.87	3.93	0.767	0.806	0.85	0.77

Note: ^aUsefulness and efficiency constructs are single item

between constructs (Fornell and Larcker, 1981), the composite reliabilities of the construct in the study and the correlations between constructs. Discriminant validity was also tested and established using Fornell and Larcker's (1981) criteria. As far as the composite reliability of each scale is concerned, all the values exceed Bagozzi and Yi's (1988) recommended cut-off point of > 0.60, suggesting that the scales are internally consistent. Finally, none of the factor correlations exceeded the 0.80 cut-off point (Grewal *et al.*, 2004; Ping, 2004), which was taken as a signal of measure distinctness. We further assessed convergent validity through the average variance extracted (AVE), using Fornell and Larcker's (1981) criteria. All the constructs had AVE values above the recommended threshold of 0.5, with the lowest AVE for efficiency scale in B's sample, 0.578 and efficiency scale in CN sample, 0.613 (please see Table IV).

Model testing and comparisons

We tested both models (B's and CN) using Lisrel 8.71 statistical package (Jöreskog and Sörbom, 2004) with sample covariance matrix as the input matrix and ML model. In our model estimation, we assessed the following:

- the directions of the relationships and whether they actually reflect the hypothesised directions;
- the strength of the hypothesised links; and
- the amount of variance in the endogenous variables explained by the respective proposed determinants.

Table V reports the regression results of analysis performed on both samples. The structural model's fit statistics are good: χ^2 (36) = 69.05; RMSEA = 0.068; CFI = 0.975; GFI = 0.954; NFI = 0.953; and standardised RMR = 0.03 for B's and χ^2 (36) = 46.53; RMSEA = 0.04; CFI = 0.995; GFI = 0.959; NFI = 0.973; and standardised RMR = 0.03 for the CN

sample. To check for mediation, we followed the procedure described by Hopwood (2007). For B's, the direct effect of non-profit brand image dimensions on intentions to donate time and money returned a good model fit of χ^2 (29) = 67.20, RMSEA = 0.081, CFI = 0.963, GFI = 0.951, NFI = 0.943 and standardised RMR = 0.03. After introducing brand typicality as a mediator, the model fit improved [χ^2 (36) = 69.05, RMSEA = 0.068, CFI = 0.975, GFI = 0.954, NFI = 0.953 and standardised RMR = 0.03]. All the paths from non-profit brand image dimensions (i.e. usefulness, efficiency, affect and dynamism) and brand typicality are strong and significant for B's. Whereas usefulness and efficiency have a positive relation to typicality, affect and dynamism will actually decrease the perception of how good an example B's is of the children and youth charity sector. Donations in time are also influenced by all dimensions of the non-profit brand image. However, after introducing typicality as a mediator, the direct link between the non-profit brand image dimensions and donations in time became non-significant. Consequently, these results indicate that typicality fully mediates the relationship between the non-profit brand image and the intention to donate time. On the other hand, typicality does not mediate the relationship between B's brand image and donations in money, nor is there a direct effect on donations in money. Regarding CN, the direct effect of non-profit brand image scales returned a good model fit of χ^2 (29) = 32.91, RMSEA = 0.03, CFI = 0.997, GFI = 0.968, NFI = 0.974 and standardised RMR = 0.023, with all effects statistically

Table IV Discriminant validity for

Dimensions	CR	1	2	3	4
Barnardo's					
Usefulness	0.7	0.70	0.25	0.22	0.18
Efficiency	0.68	0.50	0.60	0.35	0.17
Affect	0.74	0.47	0.59	0.58	0.46
Dynamism	0.65	0.43	0.41	0.68	0.65
BBC Children in Need					
Usefulness	0.7	0.70	0.34	0.36	0.30
Efficiency	0.76	0.58	0.61	0.44	0.52
Affect	0.88	0.60	0.66	0.71	0.63
Dynamism	0.73	0.55	0.72	0.80	0.73

Note: Correlations are below diagonal, squared correlations are above the diagonal, and AVE estimates are presented on the diagonal

Table V Hypotheses testing results for Barnardo's (B's) and BBC children in need (CN)

Variables	Estimate				SE				t-value				R ²			
	B's		CN		B's		CN		B's		CN		Hypothesis	B's	CN	
	D*	InD*	D	InD	D	InD	D	InD	D	InD	D	InD				
Effects on time donations															0.871	0.975
Usefulness	-5.01	-3.71	-0.84	-0.44	-3.87	-2.91	-0.62	-0.32	-1.89*	-1.43	-1.27	-0.9	H1.1a			
Efficiency	-7.36	-12.07	2.47	2.13	-4.53	-6.56	1.7	1.46	-1.88*	-1.54	2.05*	2.57**	H1.2a			
Affect	3.56	7.71	2.07	2.21	2.91	6.28	0.17	1.76	1.76*	1.56	1.95*	2.96**	H1.3a			
Dynamism	2.9	3.87	-4.00	-3.42	2.63	3.20	-3.16	-2.69	1.99*	1.61	-2.32*	-3.08**	H1.4a			
Typicality	4.93		0.87		3.43		0.63		1.83*		2.85**		H2a			
Previous donations	-0.48		-1.84		-0.16		-0.75		-1.14		-2.02*		H5a			
Effects on money donations															0.701	0.743
Usefulness	-10.02	-5.20	-0.30	-0.1	-7.74	-4.04	-0.24	0.08	-0.98	-1.07	-0.88	-0.31	H1.1b			
Efficiency	-14.82	-17.00	1.01	1.06	-9.11	-9.18	0.74	0.78	-0.97	-1.10	1.99*	2.29*	H1.2b			
Affect	6.64	10.57	1.25	1.72	5.71	8.85	0.11	1.47	0.95	1.10	2.48**	3.69**	H1.3b			
Dynamism	5.72	5.47	-2.17	-2.20	5.19	4.49	-1.82	-1.85	1.03	1.17	-3.12**	-3.61**	H1.4b			
Typicality	10.06		0.96		6.99		0.74		0.96		4.16**		H2b			
Previous donations	-0.99		-1.62		-0.34		-0.71		-2.27**		-3.27**		H5b			
Effects on typicality															0.335	0.556
Usefulness	0.961		0.24		1.06		0.25		4.69**		1.77*		H3.1			
Efficiency	1.408		-0.16		1.24		-0.15		3.99**		-0.75		H3.2			
Affect	-0.604		0.18		-0.7		0.2		-2.18*		0.99		H3.3			
Dynamism	-0.514		0.47		-0.67		0.51		-3.52**		1.93*		H3.4			
Control variables:																
Effects on time donations																
Gender	0.33		0.63				0.13		0.26		1.16	0.88				
Age	-0.09		-0.12				-0.04		-0.15		-0.36	-0.57				
Income	0.31		0.41				0.15		0.48		1.04	1.13				
Effects on money donations																
Gender	-0.05		0.09				-0.02		0.04		-0.17	0.25				
Age	-0.23		-0.11				-0.1		-0.14		-0.85	-0.87				
Income	0.47		0.19				0.22		0.23		1.57	1.04				
Notes: D=Direct effect; InD=Indirect effect; ** $p < 0.01$, * $p < 0.05$ a = critical t-values are 1.645 and 2.325 for a = 0.05 and a = 0.01 respectively (one-tailed test as all hypotheses are one-directional)																

Notes: D=Direct effect; InD=Indirect effect; ** $p < 0.01$, * $p < 0.05$ a = critical t-values are 1.645 and 2.325 for $\alpha = 0.05$ and $\alpha = 0.01$ respectively (one-tailed test as all hypotheses are one-directional)

significant, except for the link between usefulness and donations in time and money. Again, after introducing the mediator variable, typicality, the model fit improved [$\chi^2(36) = 46.53$; RMSEA = 0.04; CFI = 0.995; GFI = 0.959; NFI = 0.973; and standardised RMR = 0.03]. Most of the paths from non-profit brand image dimensions, brand typicality and non-profit brand image dimensions and donations in time and money, are strong and statistically significant. The exception is the effect of usefulness on donations in time and money; in this context, typicality mediates only partially the relationship between a non-profit brand image and the intention to donate time and money. Usefulness and dynamism are strongly and positively related to brand typicality, whereas dimensions of efficiency and affect were statistically non-significant. Furthermore, efficiency, affect and dynamism have a positive effect on donations in time through typicality and directly, whereas usefulness does not. As far as donations in money are concerned, all dimensions but usefulness are significantly related to donations in money, again both directly and through typicality. An interesting result might be observed in connection with the negative effect of dynamism on donations

in Money. It seems that the level of a charity's innovativeness will, in fact, decrease a donor's donation in money.

As far as brand typicality is concerned, it is a good predictor of donations in time in both charities, and donations in money for CN. Finally, previous donation behaviour has a negative and significant impact on donations in money for B's, and a negative and significant effect for both donations in time and money for CN. Overall, testing of the model across these two different charities from the children and youth sector showed that context is highly important. For example, where B's innovativeness will have a negative impact on the perceptions of typicality, donors will perceive CN as a good example of the children and youth sector, if they exhibit innovative behaviour. Another observation is that past donations impact differently upon intentions to donate time in these two charities; no effect in B's case and a positive effect in the case of CN. Further research is needed to explain this finding as previous experience with the specific charity, for example, spending time with the employees or in the field, may play a role in deciding to donate in the future or not. In addition, a negative and significant impact of past donations on the intention to donate money is an important indicator of a negative

behaviour that must not be overlooked. Finally, in most of the cases, typicality will have a positive impact on donating both time and money. In turn, although partially supported, our mediation test does imply that typicality mediates (fully and partially) the link between the non-profit brand image dimensions and some of the intentions to donate, indicating the importance of considering donors' perceptions and whether they perceive the particular charity as a good example of the children and youth sector or not.

Discussion and implications

This study builds on previous research by exploring the role of non-profit brand image dimensions, typicality and past donor behaviour on consumers' intentions to donate time and money in two different contexts: a "weaker charity" brand (based on the Charity Brand Index) that generates high income (i.e. B's) and a stronger brand that generates lower income compared to the former brand (i.e. CN). The study provides some insights into the factors that affect donations and illustrate the key aspects that can increase donations to charity. The theoretical model developed is strong in terms of explanatory power and explains a high proportion of variance for both time and money donations in both contexts; 87 per cent for time donations and 70 per cent for money donations for B's brand and almost 98 per cent for time and 74 per cent for money donations for CN. This research also allows for comparisons to be made between a stronger and a weaker charity brand. Our results show that B's is perceived as a more typical charity brand (mean = 5.29, SD = 1.017) than CN (mean = 3.93, SD = 0.806). Brand typicality is found to play a key role in the intention to donate time in both contexts. Interestingly, although B's is perceived as a more typical children's charity brand, the impact of brand typicality on time donations is greater for CN. Our findings corroborate previous research, which highlights that brand typicality is a significant determinant of time donations (Michel and Rieunier, 2012). However, our study differs from that of Michel and Rieunier (2012) in that we examine the mediating role of brand typicality in charitable donations in money and time between the two charity brands. Contrary to time donations, the direct effect of brand typicality on money donations seems to depend on the brand investigated. Specifically, our results illustrate that for a weaker brand, such as B's (compared to CN) which nevertheless generates a higher income, typicality does not play an important role in a consumer's intention to donate money. The results of this study suggest that brand typicality has a direct impact on time donations in both contexts and money donations (in CN). The mediating role of typicality is only partially supported in one of the two contexts investigated. Interestingly, our results indicate that none of the non-profit brand image factors explain money donations for B's. In this context, only past donations seem to influence money donations. Other factors, such as subjective norms (Ajzen, 1991) may, however, play a key role in the case of a more established charity brand that benefits from greater exposure to the public.

Brand typicality seems to be influenced by all the non-profit brand image dimensions in the case of B's but only by usefulness and dynamism in the case of CN. The additional affective factor that influences brand typicality for B's can be

attributed to the different levels of publicity the two charities have received. Indeed, brand typicality is also determined through the extent to which the public is exposed to a particular charity brand (Loken and Ward, 1990). B's has a long history and is associated with increased publicity, which could imply that more affective elements (e.g. friendliness or warmth) shape typicality perceptions. B's TV advertising campaigns have managed to increase awareness levels; it is argued that their campaigns have achieved a 21 per cent unprompted awareness, which was sustained after the end of the campaign (B's, 2012). On the contrary, when it comes to a charity brand that does not enjoy the same levels of publicity, (in this case, CN), affect is more difficult to be built and, therefore, potential donors assess the level of brand typicality using more rational criteria, including, for example, the level of service it offers to beneficiaries, or the innovativeness it has introduced.

Interestingly, past behaviour appears to affect intentions to donate both time and money only in the case of the CN charity. Past donations only seem to influence money donations in the case of B's. One possible explanation for this result is that habitual behaviour can play a greater role in the case of a charity that receives less frequent publicity, especially in the case of time donations, which is considered a more emotional process (Liu and Aaker, 2008). B's invests a lot of resources in communicating its brand and charity work widely, having generated more than 20,000 pieces of media coverage in 2011/2012 (Barnardos, 2012), while CN tends to raise awareness and invite people to donate largely through specific events or programmes throughout the year. Contrary to previous research, indicating a strong link between the non-profit brand image dimensions and the intention to donate (Michel and Rieunier, 2012), this research illustrates that the non-profit brand image factors influencing time and money donations depend upon the brand. The results highlight that when it comes to a newer brand (compared to B's), the more dynamic the brand is, the less willing potential donors are to donate both time and money. Potential donors might appreciate more an "older" or more "established" brand that does not show any modern attributes. Finally, corroborating past research indicates that time donation is more of an emotional process, whereas money donations suggest a more rational activity (e.g. Liu and Aaker, 2008); affect seems to influence time donations irrespective of the brand under investigation.

Managerial implications

This research has a number of managerial implications. First, the results highlight the important role of brand typicality in the intention to donate both time and money. Brand managers need to work on establishing typicality for their brands and this can be achieved by first understanding the public's ideal charity brand traits and trying to match these. Charities can also increase the exposure of their brand to the public and invest more in campaigns and events, in order for them to enjoy first recall. Second, brand managers are advised to work closely on their brand image and, in particular, the affective and dynamic elements to increase time donations. Time donations, being a more emotional process, are more difficult to stimulate and, therefore, this is a strategy that could

greatly benefit different charities. Third, this study highlights the need for charities and brand managers in particular, to analyse their brands and their position, *vis-à-vis* other charitable organisations within the same sector. This will determine the marketing programmes that charities need to implement to increase donations. For example, it could be argued that a relatively new charitable organisation needs to communicate a more established and traditional image, consistent with the public's "ideal" traits to encourage donations. Fourth, it appears that charities that do not invest heavily in advertising rely more upon past behaviour and, therefore, need to ensure that they have established a group of loyal donors. Consistent with the findings of this research, these charities could communicate the effectiveness of their programmes and grant awards to their donors, so that they are familiar with the areas their money has been invested in. This could also result in increased numbers of loyal donors, which are essential for charities that are not associated with a great amount of publicity (compared to other charitable organisations).

Limitations and future research

This study focusses on one charity sector, that of children. Future research should address other charity sectors and charity brands to understand whether factors affecting the intention to donate differ, based upon the sector in which a charity brand operates. In addition, future research could also investigate the effect of certain rewards or motivations on intentions to donate time and money. Previous research suggests that attitudes and behaviour towards charitable giving are shaped by different motivations (Kottasz, 2004). In line with the theory of planned behaviour (Ajzen, 1991), the role of subjective norms could improve the explanatory power of the model tested in this study and, therefore, could be included in future research to gain more insights into the role of significant others in the intention to donate. Extant evidence suggests that factors such as conformity with family wishes (Cermak *et al.*, 1994) or family utility (Sargeant *et al.*, 2006) play a key role in charity giving. This research investigates the role of brand typicality as a mediator between the non-profit brand image and the intention to donate. Other empirical research (Pillai and Goldsmith, 2008) suggests that brand typicality plays a moderating role in effects on brand attitudes. Following on from such evidence, future research could examine the role of brand typicality as a moderator. On the methodological front, this study uses a shorter version of an established scale, measuring non-profit brand image (Michel and Rieunier, 2012). Future research should focus on the scale and provide evidence that supports its validity in different non-profit contexts. Finally, previous research highlights that there could be a gap between the intention and actual behaviour in that intention is not always a good predictor of actual behaviour (Carrington *et al.*, 2010; Fukukawa, 2003). Thus, future research could investigate actual giving behaviour to enhance knowledge and practice in this area.

Note

- 1 The Charity Brand Index is based on a consumer survey and captures a number of brand characteristics, including recognition, trust, willingness to donate, effectiveness of

media coverage and advertising, attitudes towards the charity's cause and understanding of the charity's work.

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Appendix 1

Figure A1 Barnardo's income and expenditure

Income £244,984,000 ⓘ



Voluntary	£43.54m
Trading to raise funds	£38.95m
Investment	£4.01m
Charitable activities	£156.74m
Other	£1.74m
Total	£244.98m

Investment gains £2.1m ⓘ

Spending £247,330,000 ⓘ



Generating voluntary income	£11.02m
Trading to raise funds	£31.97m
Investment management	£0.25m
Charitable activities	£200.71m
Governance	£1.87m
Other	£1.51m
Total	£247.33m

Source: Charity Commission (2012b)

Figure A2 BBC children in need appeal – income and expenditure

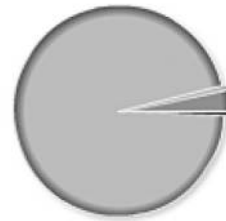
Income £44,204,000 ⓘ



Voluntary	£39.92m
Trading to raise funds	£2.65m
Investment	£1.59m
Charitable activities	£0.00m
Other	£0.04m
Total	£44.20m

Investment gains £0 ⓘ

Spending £46,974,000 ⓘ



Generating voluntary income	£1.56m
Trading to raise funds	£0.12m
Investment management	£0.09m
Charitable activities	£44.90m
Governance	£0.31m
Other	£0.00m
Total	£46.97m

Source: Charity Commission (2012b)

About the authors

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1. Nina Michaelidou, Milena Micevski, John W. Cadogan. 2015. An evaluation of nonprofit brand image: Towards a better conceptualization and measurement. *Journal of Business Research* **68**, 1657-1666. [[CrossRef](#)]